

OREGON CITY ENTERPRISE

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FOOD, FUEL SHORTAGE
REPORTED IN MID WESTCommerce Commission Order
Priority to Be Given To
Perishables and Stock.

WASHINGTON, Aug. 31.—The interstate commerce commission today declared an emergency existed on the railroads west of the Mississippi and extended its priority orders to that vast territory.

Under a previous emergency declaration the priority system was ordered only for territory east of the Mississippi, although all railroads were or had been commodities.

Declaring that "in the opinion of the commission an emergency which requires immediate action exists upon the lines of each and all the common carriers by railroads subject to the interstate commerce commission act west of the Mississippi," the commission issued service order number 24 which promulgated rules for the movement of all freight traffic in the west.

Priority in the movement of food, fuel, livestock and perishable products is ordered by the commission.

The commission's order will be effective September 1.

Damascus to Hold
Harvest Festival
On September 15

The Damascus Farm Bureau will hold an all-day harvest festival on Friday, September 15, at the C. S. Mudge hall at Damascus. Exhibits, representing the products of the community, will be on display. These will consist of vegetables, grains, grasses, shelled and in the sheaves, fruit (both fresh and canned), dairy products, poultry and household products.

An interesting program and amusements are being planned, and will begin at 10 o'clock a. m. Addresses by prominent speakers will be given in the evening. A program different than heretofore given here is being arranged for the festival by the committee in charge of the coming event, and will continue for about two hours.

Coffee and sandwiches are to be served at 12 o'clock and also in the evening.

A meeting of the committees of the Damascus Bureau will be held Tuesday evening, September 5, to consider plans for exhibits at the coming Clackamas county fair to be held at Canby. This will be the first time the organization has made an exhibit at the fair.

Rudolf Mullenhoff, of Boring, is publicity manager of the Damascus Farm Bureau.

FORMER BUSINESS MAN
SUCCUMBS AT MOLALLA

William H. Burghardt, Sr., of Salem, who died at the home of his nephew, L. L. Burghardt, of Molalla, on Tuesday evening, August 29, resided in Oregon City for a number of years, and was at one time engaged in the insurance business and interested in mining.

Mr. Burghardt, while resident of Oregon City, was an active member of St. Paul's Episcopal church, and after moving to Salem continued his work in the Episcopal church of that city.

He is survived by his son, William Burghardt, a young business man of Salem, who was also a resident of Oregon City, and by his nephew, L. L. Burghardt, of Molalla; and a brother, Mark Burghardt, of Bloomington, Ill. Burghardt, Mass., February 2, 1837, and later resided in Michigan and in the south. When a young man in Michigan he entered the service during the Civil War, becoming a member of the Second Kentucky Cavalry.

In 1891 he came to Oregon, making his home in Oregon City until moving to Salem.

State Engineer To
Attend Molalla Meet

SALEM, Aug. 31.—The latest proof that irrigation is taking hold in the Willamette valley is the proposal to organize an irrigation district at Molalla, Clackamas county, embracing a tract of from 5000 to 10,000 acres. Percy A. Cupper, state engineer, went to Molalla last night to confer with the backers of the proposed project.

British Reduce Navy
To Fulfill Orders

LONDON, Aug. 31.—In accordance with the Washington naval agreement, the admiralty has ordered six large capital ships scrapped. They are the battle cruisers Lion and Princess Royal, and the battleships Orion, Monarch, Conqueror and Erin, all among the most famous warships in the British navy.

COUNTY FAIR WILL HAVE
LARGE POULTRY EXHIBITImprovements to Be Made On
Buildings; Other Sections
To Enter High Class Birds.

CANBY, Ore., Sept. 4.—At the Clackamas county fair which is to be held here September 19 to 22, the poultry exhibit will be among the leading events of the show. C. R. Quinn, who had charge of this department last year, is superintendent for the 1922 show, and is greatly encouraged over the prospects of having some of the leading poultry fanciers exhibiting this year. Letters from various parts of the state are arriving daily from poultrymen who are to show here and then proceed to the state fair the following week.

Indications denote a larger entry than even last year, although all space was taken at that time. Not only will Clackamas county be largely represented but other counties as well.

The list of special prizes is larger this year, and covers a greater variety of breeds than last year.

Improvements have been made to the poultry building. A new roof, with three skylights has been put on the building and the interior whitewashed.

A new feature in the poultry premium list for this year is the egg contest. While one was conducted last year, it was at an "eleventh hour" idea, and received little publicity. It proved a popular idea with those who heard about it however, and the feature is to be one of the big events of the fair of 1922.

There are many special prizes offered in the poultry department this year. The Canby and Oregon City banks have donated liberally. A number of Portland and Canby firms have also offered prizes in the department.

Hazelia and Damascus are among the other communities to exhibit this year. There will also be several other granges. Warner Grange which has not missed a county fair in the past fifteen years will be on hand again this year, and will compete for the first prize.

Services Are Held
By Bible Students

Three youths from the Northwest Bible and Missionary Training School at Minneapolis held services Sunday at the Congregational church at Park place, and at the Outlook, Swedish Methodist, Episcopal church. The boys are H. M. Sippel, and Cecil Wilson, of Rochester, N. Y., and Paul Lindholm, of Ortonville, Minn. They are touring the country in an automobile, giving sermons as they go along. They have traveled across the country, from New York to Seattle, down to San Francisco, and are now on their way back to Minneapolis to attend the fall term of the school.

Abstract Company
And Eby Will Move

The law offices of O. D. Eby, attorney, and the Clackamas Abstract & Trust Company will be moved from the recently damaged Bank of Oregon City building to the Andersen building. Both concerns will occupy the rooms recently vacated by the law firm, Dimick & Mulvey.

COMMISSION ACCEPTS
BELGIAN COMPROMISE

PARIS, Aug. 31.—The allied reparations commission has decided to accept the Belgian compromise on the German moratorium proposition as a solution of the present crisis, it was learned this afternoon. A formal vote will be taken before the day is over, it was stated.

The British, Italian and Belgian members are declared unequivocally to favor this settlement. The attitude of M. Dubois, the French member, was not definitely known when the early afternoon session of the commission adjourned.

Two Dallas Men
Hit By Lightning

DALLAS, Aug. 31.—John McDonald and C. E. Vining, two Dallas men employed at the Matlock lumber mill about three miles west of this city, were severely burned by lightning yesterday when a tree under which they had taken refuge during a severe rain storm was struck. Both were knocked down by the bolt and McDonald rendered unconscious. He was severely burned about the neck and one side. Vining was not so seriously hurt, but was burned in several places about his body.

MORTALITY OF FEDERAL
DRY AGENTS SET AT 24

WASHINGTON, Sept. 5.—A report from Federal Prohibition Director Linville of Oregon on the death of Agents Grover and Glenn Price, in a raid near Dallas, Ore., brings the total of known mortalities among federal dry law enforcement agents killed in the line of duty to twenty-four. It is announced today by prohibition headquarters.

CONFERENCES

Between Shopmen and
Railroad ExecutivesFAIL TO BRING
Favorable Conditions;
Outlook Not Good For
SETTLEMENT

By Robert E. Smith

President of the Lumberman's Trust Company Bank, Portland, Oregon

The strike of the highway shopmen seems to defy all efforts at settlement. On the one hand the strikers are offering to go back to work on the promise that there will be a re-hearing of their case before the Labor Board but insist that their seniority rights be restored. The rail executives on the other hand insist that the men should return to work as new employees. repeated conferences, all of which were preceded by high hopes of settlement, have failed and the outlook at this writing is very pessimistic.

The strike of bituminous coal miners seems to be definitely over, work at the mines being resumed in the great majority of districts during the past week. In the anthracite regions the miners and operators have been unable to get together. But for the coal strike they would be moving a much larger traffic and earning more money than they now are. In the four weeks ending July 1 last, their total freight business, excepting coal, was over 200,000 carloads more than the same weeks in 1920. In these four weeks of 1920 the total number of cars loaded with freight was 3,651,000. If there had been as many cars of coal shipped in these weeks of 1922 as there were in the corresponding weeks of 1920 the total cars of freight shipped would have been 3,851,723. It therefore, appears certain that with the resumption of coal movement now that the strike has been settled the railroad will get additional tonnage to substantially increase their net earnings. Briefly stated, the gross earnings of all railroads for June 1922, showed an increase of 2.69% over 1921 while expenses were reduced 4.64%. It is very evident that net earnings on railroad capitalization are largely the result of management as reflected in savings on operating costs.

WORKERS' PAY INCREASED.

One of the big surprises of the week was the announcement of the United States Steel Corporation of a voluntary increase of 20% in the pay of its common labor. Practically all common labor in the bituminous coal mines has followed suit. It is explained that the present immigration laws, which limit the entrance of foreigners in this country to a small percentage of their nationals already residing here, has led to a shortage of common labor. Settlement of the coal strike also resulted in the loss by the steel companies of large numbers of men temporarily employed by them. Coming at a time when the general tendency of wage scales is downward, this increase took the country entirely by surprise and resulted in a downward fluctuation of steel stocks on the New York Exchange.

BILL UNCERTAIN.

The actual future of the pending tariff bill still remains uncertain. Probably, however, it will come to a vote in the Senate within a month or less. There is a good deal of opposition to the bill, however, throughout the country and it is clear that very strong pressure will be brought to bear upon the president to induce him not to assent to the immediate adoption of the measure. Evidence of disfavor which the new schedule have invoked have been so obvious as to not permit their overlooking. Many people feel that world industry is in such a condition of flux that schedules cannot be intelligently made at this time, and that, industrially, it would be a good thing to postpone tariff action until a great many more facts are available to show what duties are actually required in view of the changing condition of European trade and industry.

Last figures show an estimate of crop yield for the year valued at \$7,135,000,000, an indicated increase of about \$1,200,000,000 over 1921. This situation is important from the standpoint of the consumer. How far will enable the farmer to command manufactured goods depends upon the general movement of prices. At present export conditions are not satisfactory and the foreign situation does not promise an exceptionally good demand for farm products during the current year.

The disturbed exchange condition and the uncertainty that marks all European enterprises are doubtless responsible for much of the doubt. It is to be feared also that the pending tariff legislation may raise prices of goods while cutting off the farmers foreign markets. The real wealth of the country will have been actually increased but it is doubtful whether it will accrue to its actual producers. The level of prices paid producers for the principal crops decreased about 8.10% during July. On August 1 the index figure of prices was about 8.8% higher than a year ago, but 55.9% lower than two years ago. The prices of meat animals decreased 4.10% of 1%. On July 15 the index figure of prices for these meat animals was about 9.10% higher than a year ago, but 32.7% below 1922.

GROCERS ARE EXONERATED.

An inquiry conducted by a congressional committee has resulted in a report exonerating grocers from the general public charge that they are profiteering. Of the proceeds from 9476 car loads of agricultural products sold at wholesale from September 1920 to July 1921 in such representative cities as Boston, New York, Pittsburgh and Philadelphia, the report indicates that 60% went to the producer, 31% paid for transportation and 5% for miscellaneous handling charges, leaving only 4% for profits. The conclusion is evident; it is the handling and transportation and not the grocer's greed that stretches the bridge between producers and consumers. The commission recommends among other things standardization of production. The farmers should, as far as possible, specialize in those crops for which he has a demand in the market. Where shipping is necessary, careful selection and grading of varieties will eliminate the present unnecessary waste from culling after the products leave the farmers' hands. The commission regards co-operative marketing organizations as especially adapted for developing a more uniform and standardized production. Minimized shipping movements and better organization of terminal facilities are urged in order to dispense with the unnecessary waste of labor.

FARM POPULATION LESS.

United States census bureau has just made public the result of its enumeration of the distinctive farm population of the country on the last census date, January 1, 1920. It appears that on that date out of the total population of 51,406,017 classed as rural there were actually living on the farms 31,614,259 persons. This number includes 255,629 persons living on farms situated within the limits of cities and other incorporated communities having a population of 2500 or more. The farm population proper represented 29.9% of the entire population of the United States and 61% of the so-called rural population. The ratio of the farm population to the total population ranges from 2.5 in Rhode Island to 71% in Mississippi.

TREND OF RAILROAD EARNINGS.

In the first five months of 1922 the class one roads—those earning more than one million gross a year—earned a net of \$279,000,000. This was at the annual rate of 4.36% on the valuation placed on them by the Interstate Commerce Commission. If during these five months both the wage and rate reduction made on July first had been in effect and all other conditions had been as they were, the net return earned would have been only about \$228,000,000 or at the annual rate of approximately 3.8 on the valuation. There is no immediate prospect of further substantial reduction in railroad operating costs. But for the coal strike they would be moving a much larger traffic and earning more money than they now are. In the four weeks ending July 1 last, their total freight business, excepting coal, was over 200,000 carloads more than the same weeks in 1920. In these four weeks of 1920 the total number of cars loaded with freight was 3,651,000. If there had been as many cars of coal shipped in these weeks of 1922 as there were in the corresponding weeks of 1920 the total cars of freight shipped would have been 3,851,723. It therefore, appears certain that with the resumption of coal movement now that the strike has been settled the railroad will get additional tonnage to substantially increase their net earnings. Briefly stated, the gross earnings of all railroads for June 1922, showed an increase of 2.69% over 1921 while expenses were reduced 4.64%. It is very evident that net earnings on railroad capitalization are largely the result of management as reflected in savings on operating costs.

ITEMS THAT INTEREST.

The per capita circulation of money on July 1 of this year was \$39.87 compared with \$44.78 in July 1921. Estimates of the world's total production of cane and beet sugar for 1921-1922 are 17,325,000 tons, which represents a gain of 643,151 tons over the total for one year ago. The estimate for 1922 wheat harvest for all countries, 2,753,386,000 bushels, is slightly higher than in 1921 and compares with the five year average of 2,557,000,000 bushels.

JUNE PRODUCTION IN THE AUTOMOBILE INDUSTRY ESTABLISHED A NEW HIGH RECORD.

The total, 288,000 cars, was 12% higher than the May figures. The total for the first six months in 1922 was 1,137,000 cars and indicators are that production for the entire year will reach the two million mark. Unfilled orders of the U. S. Steel Corporation on July 31 rose to 5,635,531 tons, an increase of 140,630. This indicates that incoming business during the month was fully at 85% of capacity. Iron ore shipments from the upper lake ports in July totaled \$942,336 tons gross, an increase of 121 percent over July 1921. Copper is quiet with prices unchanged. With reduced stocks, however, a rise is looked for. Copper sales during July in domestic and foreign markets are estimated at 125,000,000 pounds, against 140,000,000 in June and 210,000,000 in May. Shipments in July are estimated at 100,000,000 pounds. The July output of the Transvaal gold mines jumped to 730,635 fine ounces from 675,697 in June.

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AMERICANS BECOMING SAVERS.

The extent to which saving has been stimulated in the United States has been shown by recently published statistics. We have about 21,000,000 families and more than 1,000,000 savings accounts. There are 4,500,000 share holders in building and loan associations, whose accounts are growing by regular deposits and besides there are many who are buying securities on the installment plan. In 1916 the number of savings accounts was estimated at 22,000,000. The increase of 9,000,000 since that time must be regarded as phenomenal.

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FOREIGN TRADE FAVORABLE.

Exports from the United States for the fiscal year ended June 30, totaled \$3,770,000,000 and imports \$2,608,000,000 leaving a favorable trade balance in our favor of \$1,162,000,000 which was a decline of nearly \$2,000,000,000 from the favorable balance of the previous year. Although exports for the year fell off by nearly \$3,000,000,000 compared with the previous year, they showed an increase of nearly \$1,500,000,000 compared with the fiscal year 1921, and imports for last year which declined by over \$1,000,000,000 as against 1921 resulted in an increase of \$700,000,000 over 1921. Exports for June, \$334,000,000, were the highest since October 1921, when the total was \$343,000,000 while imports for June, \$260,000,000, were the highest since December 1920, when the total was \$266,000,000.

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A special bureau of the Chicago Association of Commerce, which

has been in existence only three years, has already investigated \$590,000,000 worth of securities. At the recommendation of the officials of this bureau, the state withheld from the market \$62,000,000 in securities. During four months of the present year security brokers were forced to refund more than \$175,000. Every business man whether he is a retailer or a manufacturer should help fight fake securities. In protecting the public they are only protecting their own best interests.

IN FOREIGN COUNTRIES.

Despite huge increase in its note circulation which now stands at 211,000,000,000 marks, money is reported tight in Germany. This tightness is explained by the fact that money depreciates faster than any possible rate of interest to compensate for it and no one cares to loan it. "Spend it quick, lest it spoil" seems to be the universal motto. The price of white bread jumped from 10 million to 30 million rubles per pound in Russia in one day. Cost of living in Austria for August is estimated at 94% in excess of cost for July. Austrian currency was increased by 46% during the first half of the year. The Austrian National Bank has fixed the ratio of valuation of paper and gold to 4670 to 1. President Obregon of Mexico has signed the debt agreement, the press generally approving, though doubts of the approval of the Mexican Congress are expressed. Under this agreement Mexico is to resume payment of interest on its external debt beginning with January of next year. Brazil has extended the valorization principle to a large number of agricultural and pastoral products, the purpose being the protection and fostering of the national production. Under the scheme the government finance producers with a view to maintaining prices by marketing over an extended period of time rather than permitting the market